Blog Post Structure

Layer 1: Page structure

What this page is for

Every client gets about 15 blog posts in the first four months, then one a month. Each post targets one customer question, not a money keyword: "Do I need planning permission for a front drive in Southampton?", "Why is my lawn waterlogged?", "Turf or seed?".

Rank for that question in organic results, and **get cited in AI answers** (AI Overviews, ChatGPT), by answering first, using the question as headings and carrying local detail a national site can't. Each post passes authority **up** to the one service or category page that sells the job (or the homepage, when the service has neither).

Convert the few readers who are ready, with one clear next step to that page. A blog post never tries to be a sales page.

There are four post types on one template: **question**, **decision**, **local** (seasonal is a local post with a time of year) and **cost guide**. Code picks the type; the sections stay the same, and switches turn the table and the business block on or off.

Cost guides have their own page structure tab (Cost Guide Structure, owned by Brandon), as agreed in the v1 page set. That tab sets what a cost guide covers; it runs on this template as post_type cost_guide, so it shares the same sections, fields, URL pattern and schema as every other post.

What this page owns

Its target query, its query stack (the 3 to 5 questions around it) and its FAQs. Nothing else on the site answers them. It owns **no proofs**: the years, guarantee, insurance and reviews live on the homepage, and a post only mentions a confirmed proof in its business block. It never repeats an FAQ used on any other page.

The page on one page

#	Section	What's in it	Why
1	Post header	Breadcrumb, H1 = the question, byline, last checked date, real photo if one exists	Rank: question in the H1. Convert: a real business, recently checked
2	Quick answer	40 to 60 words answering the H1 directly, in a styled box	Rank: the block AI answers lift. Convert: the answer before the scroll
3	Question sections	3 to 5 H2s, each a question people ask around the topic, each answered in its first sentence	Rank: the query stack as subheadings. Convert: every follow up answered

#	Section	What's in it	Why
4	Table (switch)	Prices, options, timings or rules, in columns	Rank: tables get lifted into AI answers. Convert: easy to compare
5	How we handle it (switch)	50 to 80 words on how this business does the job, from confirmed values	Convert: the bridge from advice to the business
6	FAQ	3 to 5 questions not used anywhere else on the site, all visible	Rank: FAQ schema. Convert: last doubts
7	Next step	Heading, one or two sentences linking the primary page, buttons	Rank: authority up to the service page. Convert: the one ask

Around them: header, mobile sticky bar, footer, and the breadcrumb Home › Guides › [H1].

Length: question and decision posts 800 to 1,200 words; local and seasonal 700 to 1,000; cost guides 1,000 to 1,500. **Images:** one real job photo if the client has one that fits; otherwise none. Never stock.

The sections

1. Post header

H1: the target question from the Page Map, in title case, ending with a question mark, e.g. Do You Need Planning Permission to Pave Your Front Garden? 70 characters at most.

Contains: the breadcrumb; the byline ("By [CV: owner_name], [owner role] at [CV: company_name]", or "By [CV: company_name]" with no owner); "Last checked [date]"; one real job photo when the client has one that fits the topic.

Rank: the question in the H1 and the URL. Convert: a named local business, checked recently.

2. Quick answer

No heading (a styled box under the header).

Contains: the direct answer to the H1, first sentence 20 words or fewer, then the one thing that changes the answer most. Cost guides: the typical range from the price list, or what moves the price.

Words: 40 to 60.

Rank: the block AI answers and featured snippets lift. Convert: answers the visitor before they scroll.

3. Question sections

H2s: 3 to 5 questions from the query stack, each as a person would type it, e.g. Do You Need a Dropped Kerb in Southampton?

Contains: under each H2, a first sentence that answers it, then 2 or 3 short paragraphs with facts from the trade facts, the dossier or client values. The primary link appears once, in the first or second section.

Words: 120 to 220 per section, by post type.

Rank: the query stack as subheadings, each answer quotable on its own. Convert: every follow up question answered on the page.

4. Table (switch: table)

No H2 of its own; sits inside the section it belongs to.

Contains: columns and row labels set by code for the post type (cost guide: job, typical price, what affects it; decision: option, suits, cost level, upkeep; question: cause, sign, fix; rules: situation, usually needs permission?). Cells from facts only; a cell with no fact reads "Ask for a quote".

Words: 2 to 12 per cell.

Rank: structured answers AI tools lift. Convert: easy to compare at a glance.

5. How we handle it (switch: business_block)

H2: How [CV: company_name] Handles [TOPIC].

Contains: how this business does the job: its quote method, process, guarantee or accreditation, from confirmed client values only. Hidden with fewer than two confirmed facts.

Words: 50 to 80.

Convert: turns advice into a reason to use this business, without a sales pitch.

6. FAQ

H2: Common Questions About [TOPIC].

Contains: 3 to 5 visible questions, none used on any other page of the site, each answered in its first sentence.

Words: 40 to 70 per answer.

Rank: FAQPage schema. Convert: the last doubts answered.

7. Next step

H2: the niche's blog heading, e.g. Talk to a Local [TRADE_PERSON] About [TOPIC].

Contains: one or two sentences pointing to the primary page, linked once; the [PRIMARY_ACTION] and Call buttons. Never the phone number in the text.

Words: 20 to 40.

Rank: authority passed up to the service page. Convert: the one ask.

Locked decisions

H1 = the target question; answer first in the quick answer, each H2 and each FAQ; one primary link up to a live service page, category page or the homepage; links only to live pages; never a stock image; FAQs never used elsewhere on the site; every post, cost guides included, lives at /guides/[slug]/; the first 3 posts (the homepage cost guide and the first two service cost guides) go live with the site and the rest

are scheduled in advance; cost guides have their own structure tab and run on this template. Still open: price ranges, the byline, and the specificity threshold for thin niches (section 11).

Layer 2: Copybot and build detail

1. How this structure works

One blog structure for every niche and every post type. The structure never changes; code picks the topic, the type and every heading before the model writes a word, and switches turn the table and the business block on or off.

Two layers. The copy spec (sections 2 to 9) is what Copybot follows; it becomes Blog CORE (1) (draft in Appendix A). The build spec (section 10) is what Given builds in WordPress.

Who decides each field uses the same codes as the homepage: **CODE** (Copybot's code works it out), **MODEL** (the model writes it to the brief), **NICHE** (word for word from the niche slot entry), **CV** (a [CV: key] token), **HUMAN** (Ray or Given at build), **FIXED** (set by this structure).

Custom values stay as [CV: key] tokens, exactly as on the homepage.

Switches

Switch	Options	Default	What it changes
post_type	question / decision / local / cost_guide	from the Page Map	Word ranges, the table columns, the quick answer brief
table	on / off	on for cost_guide and decision; off otherwise unless code has 3+ rows of facts	Section 4 shows or is removed
business_block	on / off	on when 2+ confirmed facts	Section 5 shows or is removed
cost_mode	prices / factors	prices when [CV: price_list] has this service	Cost guides only: figures, or what moves the price
safety	on / off	from the niche safety topics	Gas, electrical or structural topics: no DIY steps

2. Inputs

If an input is missing or the minimum page gate fails, that post doesn't run and the next topic in the queue takes its slot. Nothing is guessed.

Input	Holds	Notes
Page Map	One row per post, with the columns below	Read by code
Client values	Every [CV: key] the homepage uses	Same cleaned values as the homepage
FAQ research	The "Kept for a Cost Guide page" and "No page for these" buckets, approved wording, doubt, service, town	The topic queue. Only approved questions are used
Trade facts pack	Rows for the post's service: process, what goes wrong, rules, timings, price factors	Must be verified on the Trade facts page
Geo dossiers	Local conditions per town	Local posts use their town's dossier
Niche slot entry	The blog slots in section 3	Picked by the trade

Page Map columns for blog rows:

Column	Values
Page Type	Blog
Post type	question / decision / local / cost_guide
Target query	The H1 question
Query stack	3 to 5 FAQ research IDs for the H2s
FAQ IDs	3 to 5 FAQ research IDs for section 6
Primary link / Secondary links	URLs
Town	Local posts only
Homepage cost guide	yes on the one trade level cost guide (read by the homepage FAQ Q1)
Publish date	Set by code (B10)
Status, Link status	As now (Live / Launching / Scheduled / Not built)
Last checked / Review due	Dates

What code passes to the model (same five blocks as the homepage): POST (type, URL, target query, service, town); DECISIONS (H1, H2s with briefs, table columns and rows, FAQ questions, links, switches); FACTS ALLOWED (client values, trade facts rows and dossier rows, each with an ID); LINKABLE PAGES; MODEL FIELDS. IDEAS USED ELSEWHERE rides with the allocated items.

Minimum page gate

Check	Gate flag
Target query filled and approved	G-TOPIC
4 of the 6 specificity facts available (B9)	G-SPECIFIC (topic skipped, next one runs)
Primary link page is Live or Launching	G-PRIMARY
Trade facts pack verified (question, decision and cost guide posts)	G-FACTS
[CV: company_name] and [CV: phone] filled	G-INPUT

3. Niche slot additions

Blogs reuse the homepage slots (trade, trade_person, customer_type, primary_action, business_type and so on) and add these. Each starts from the business type default.

Slot	Holds	Example (landscaper)
seasonal	yes / no	yes
seasonal_topics	Topic, the window it matters, the month to publish. **Shared with the quarterly GBP post batch**, so blog and GBP posts follow one seasonal calendar	Lay new turf: Sept to Oct, publish Aug · Prepare the garden for winter: Nov, publish Oct
safety_topics	Topics that get the safety switch	Electrics for garden lighting
blog_cta_h2	Section 7 heading	Talk to a Local [TRADE_PERSON] About [TOPIC]
cost_unit	How a cost guide prices the job	per job (A) / per visit (B) / per session (C) / per move (D)
decision_pairs	Common "X or Y" choices, from the niche library	Turf or seed · Porcelain or sandstone · Composite or timber decking

Business type defaults for blog_cta_h2: A and D: Talk to a Local [TRADE_PERSON] About [TOPIC]. B: Book a Local [TRADE_PERSON] for [TOPIC]. C: per pet niche, matching its primary_action (e.g. Book a Meet and Greet With a Local [TRADE_PERSON]).

GBP posts and the seasonal calendar: the quarterly GBP batch reads the same seasonal_topics, so a seasonal topic gets a GBP post in the same month its blog post publishes, linking to it once live. The batch never runs the same topic as a blog post in a different month.

4. Global copy rules

Everything in Homepage section 4 and prompts/_shared_copy_rules.md applies: claims, voice, one home per proof, links, names in prose, custom values. Blogs add:

- **Answer first.** The quick answer, every H2 body and every FAQ answer opens with the answer, not with context.
- **The customer's words.** When the FAQ research gives a customer question in their own words, it's used once, in section 3.
- **No stories.** Never a scenario, an anecdote, "picture this" or an imagined customer. A real customer question is the only story allowed.
- **Rules and planning** are written as what usually applies ("usually", "in most cases"), never as legal advice, never with a standard's number or a regulation's name. Say who to check with: the council or building control.
- **Safety switch on:** what to switch off or avoid, then call a qualified professional. Never DIY steps.
- **Figures:** prices only from [CV: price_list]. Council fees and rules only from trade facts or dossier rows, written as checked on the post's last checked date. One figure per paragraph.
- **No proof headlines.** Years, guarantee, insurance and review counts appear only in section 5, and only as confirmed.
- **Allocation:** a post never makes a point listed in IDEAS USED ELSEWHERE, and never uses a neighbourhood or symptom allocated to another page in the same town.
- **Links:** the primary link twice at most (section 3 and section 7); each secondary link once; other blog posts only when on LINKABLE PAGES.

5. Code decisions

Code works these out before the model writes, and passes the results in DECISIONS. Each is a rule on the inputs, so it gives the same answer every run.

Topic and schedule

B1. Topic queue. Built once per client after the FAQ research is approved. Order, as agreed:

- **Cost guides:** first one trade level cost guide ("[TRADE] cost in [CITY]", marked Homepage cost guide in the Page Map, read by the homepage FAQ Q1), then one for each of the three main services (from "Kept for a Cost Guide page", else one per main service).
- **Customer question posts:** "No page for these" questions, customer questions in their own words first. Questions that compare two options (decision_pairs that match the client's services) run as decision posts; the rest run as question posts.
- **Local and seasonal posts:** one per town with a dossier condition not used elsewhere; seasonal topics slot in by B10.

A question already used on any page is never a topic.

B2. Post type: cost question → cost_guide; "X or Y", "do I need", "repair or replace" → decision; depends on a town → local; else question.

B3. H1: the approved FAQ wording, title case, with the primary city added when the question doesn't depend on one town and has room. 70 characters maximum; over that, drop the city.

B4. SEO title: "[H1 without the question mark] | [CV: company_name]", 60 characters maximum. Over 60: drop the company name. Still over: shorten to the target query's keyword words. Never "Ultimate guide", "Everything you need to know" or a year.

B5. Meta description: "[Quick answer sentence 1] [meta_cta]", 155 characters maximum. Code takes the model's first sentence after validation. Over 155: drop meta_cta. Still over: F-LEN-META.

B6. Query stack H2s: 3 to 5 approved FAQ research questions with the same service (and town, for local posts) not used anywhere else, in order of doubt: Fit, Process, Price, Timing, Trust. Fewer than 3: the post runs with what it has and flags F-STACK. Each carries a one line brief from its doubt.

B7. FAQ questions: the next 3 to 5 unused questions in the same cluster after B6. Never used on another page or another post.

B8. Links. Primary, in this order: the service page for the post's service; no service page, its category page; neither (a category with fewer than 3 services), the homepage services section (/#services). It must be Live or Launching (G-PRIMARY). The homepage cost guide's primary link is the homepage. Secondary (up to 2): that service's cost guide if live (not on cost guides); the town's Location or Location category page on local posts.

B9. Specificity test. Count which of the six are available for this post: a price for the service, a named town, a dossier condition, a customer question in their own words, a confirmed process or proof, named methods or symptoms from trade facts. Under 4: G-SPECIFIC.

B10. Publish date. Launch: the first 3 posts (the homepage cost guide and the first two service cost guides). Then 2, 4, 3, 2 posts in months one to four (5 in month one including launch), then 1 a month, spaced evenly. A seasonal topic is moved to the month before its window and may push a question post back; its GBP post publishes the same month.

Page shape

B11. Table: on for cost_guide and decision; on for question and local only when 3 or more fact rows fit the type's columns. Columns by type as in Layer 1, section 4.

B12. Business block: on when 2 or more of [CV: quote_method], confirmed practices, guarantee, insurance, accreditation or years are set.

B13. Byline: [CV: owner_name] with [CV: owner_qualification] or "owner" as the role when set; else [CV: company_name].

B14. Dates. Last checked = generation date. Review due = 12 months on when the post states a fee, price or rule; else 24 months.

B15. Safety: on when the topic matches the niche safety_topics or a trade facts rule row marked gas, electrical or structural.

6. Section specs

Sections run in this order. Each table lists every field with its ACF name. The field names match the Blog CORE (1) output labels.

1. Post header (blog_header)

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
blog_h1	CODE (B3)	The target question, 70 characters maximum	Gate G-TOPIC
seo_title / meta_description	CODE (B4, B5)	Rank Math fields	F-LEN-META
blog_byline	CODE (B13)	"By [name], [role] at [CV: company_name]"	"By [CV: company_name]"
blog_last_checked	CODE (B14)	Date shown as "Last checked 26 October 2026"	Generation date
blog_review_due	CODE (B14)	Not shown; read by the monthly review	
blog_image / blog_image_alt	HUMAN	Real job photo fitting the topic; alt says what and where	No image

2. Quick answer (blog_answer)

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
blog_answer	MODEL	40 to 60 words. First sentence answers the H1 in 20 words or fewer; then the one thing that changes the answer most. Never opens on the company name	Never empty

3. Question sections (blog_sections, repeater)

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
section_h2	CODE (B6)	Approved FAQ research wording	Fewer rows (F-STACK)
section_body	MODEL	First sentence answers its H2; 2 or 3 paragraphs; one fact from FACTS ALLOWED per paragraph. Words: cost guide 150 to 220, question and decision 140 to 200, local 120 to 180. Primary link once in row 1 or 2	Never empty

4. Table (blog_table)

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
table_show	CODE (B11)	true / false	false
table_after	CODE	Which section_h2 the table sits under	Row 1
table_columns	CODE	By post type	

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
table_rows: row_label	CODE	From facts that fit the columns	
table_rows: cells	MODEL	2 to 12 words per cell, facts only; no fact: "Ask for a quote"	

5. How we handle it (blog_business)

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
blog_business_show	CODE (B12)	true / false	false
blog_business_h2	CODE	How [CV: company_name] Handles [TOPIC]	
blog_business	MODEL	50 to 80 words, confirmed client values only, written as what happens	HIDDEN

6. FAQ (blog_faq)

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
blog_faq_h2	CODE	Common Questions About [TOPIC]	
faq_question	CODE (B7)	3 to 5, never used elsewhere	Fewer questions
faq_answer	MODEL	40 to 70 words; first sentence answers in 15 words or fewer	Never empty

7. Next step (blog_cta)

Field	Decided by	Rule	If missing
blog_cta_h2	NICHE	blog_cta_h2	
blog_closing	MODEL	20 to 40 words; the primary link once; never [CV: phone]; never "Tell us"	Never empty
Buttons	NICHE + CODE	[PRIMARY_ACTION] to /contact/ and "Call [CV: phone]" (Call first on emergency layout)	Always shown

7. Scaling rules

The same structure has to hold from a dog walker with 4 services to a builder with 40.

What varies	Range	Rule
Topics in the queue	Under 15 to 50+	Under 15 after B1: local posts fill the gap (one per town with an unused dossier condition). Still short:

What varies	Range	Rule
		F-QUEUE, and the cadence stops at the last topic rather than padding
Query stack	3 to 5	Fewer than 3: F-STACK, post runs shorter
Price list	None to every service	None: every cost guide runs cost_mode factors, flagged in the Page Map for upgrade
Business type	A, B, C, D	Cost guides price by cost_unit; C and D swap "quote" wording as on the homepage
Seasonal	yes / no	no: seasonal_topics ignored, local posts take their slots
No service or category page for a topic	Small clients	Primary link falls back to the homepage services section (B8)
Thin niches (scaffolding, blinds)	Few customer questions	Specificity threshold may drop to 3 from month four (open item)

Page length: within the post type range. Short after the first draft: expand section 3 bodies to the top of their range, then FAQ answers, from facts only. Never pad. Still short: publish with F-WORDS.

8. Output contract and flags

The model writes only its fields, in this order, with these labels. Code merges them with the CODE, NICHE and CV fields into one page record for the WordPress push. Inline links are Markdown; nothing else is.

```
=== MODEL OUTPUT: blog ===
blog_answer:
blog_sections:
  - h2: <as given> | body:
blog_table:
  - row: <as given> | cells: <cell> ; <cell> ; <cell>
blog_business:
blog_faq_items:
  - faq_question: <as given> | faq_answer:
blog_closing:
MODEL_FLAGS:
```

A field marked HIDDEN in DECISIONS is written as HIDDEN.

Code	Meaning	Effect
G-TOPIC	No approved target query	Post skipped
G-SPECIFIC	Under 4 of the 6 specificity facts	Post skipped, next topic runs

Code	Meaning	Effect
G-PRIMARY	Primary link page not Live or Launching	Post waits
G-FACTS	Trade facts pack unverified	Post waits
G-INPUT	Company name or phone missing	Run stops
F-STACK	Fewer than 3 query stack questions	Look before publishing
F-QUEUE	Fewer than 15 topics for the cadence	Cadence shortened
F-FACTS-THIN	Under 3 trade facts rows for the topic (model)	Look before publishing
F-SAFETY	Safety topic, and how it was handled (model)	Lead reviews
F-LEN-TITLE / F-LEN-META	Title over 60 or meta over 155 at their shortest	Look before publishing
F-WORDS	Under the post type range after expansion	Publish
F-REVIEW-DUE	Past its review date	Recheck facts, regenerate if changed

9. Validator alignment

Every shared check from Homepage section 9 runs on blog MODEL fields: dashes and hyphenated compounds, banned phrases, [CLIENT TO CONFIRM], template leftovers, unknown [CV: key] tokens, weak link phrases, N2 (links on LINKABLE PAGES), N5 (claim words), N6 (HIDDEN vs empty) and N7 (sentence length and word ranges). Plus claims review, as on every v20 page.

New checks for blogs:

#	Check	Class
B-N1	First sentence of blog_answer over 20 words, or of a faq_answer over 15	FLAG
B-N2	Primary link missing, or used more than twice	BLOCK
B-N3	A price not in [CV: price_list] (any £ figure, except council fees from a FACTS ALLOWED row)	BLOCK
B-N4	A standard's number or regulation name (BS, EN, "Regulations 20…", "Part P")	BLOCK
B-N5	Story markers: "imagine", "picture this", "let's say", invented names	FLAG
B-N6	Safety switch on and an instruction to dismantle, rewire, cut, reconnect or repair	BLOCK
B-N7	An FAQ question already used on another page or post	BLOCK

#	Check	Class
B-N8	A point listed in IDEAS USED ELSEWHERE repeated	FLAG
B-N9	A paragraph with no fact ID behind it (claims review)	FLAG

10. Build spec (WordPress)

This part is for Given and Ray. Copybot never sees it.

Post type and URLs. Every blog post, cost guides included, is a WordPress **post** in one category, "Guides", at /guides/[slug]/ from the Page Map, e.g. /guides/patio-cost-southampton/. The service page prices section, the category page cost section and the homepage FAQ all link to cost guides at this pattern. A "Guides" archive page lists them newest first. Navigation: Guides sits under About, or in the footer until there are 5 posts.

Template. One Elementor single post template reading the blog ACF fields. It reuses the homepage master components: header, breadcrumb trail, visible FAQ list, final CTA and the mobile sticky bar.

Scheduling. Posts after launch are scheduled in WordPress with their publish date (status Scheduled). Given schedules by hand until the Copybot push writes to posts with a future date.

Schema.

- BlogPosting: headline (blog_h1), author (the byline name), datePublished, dateModified (blog_last_checked), image when set, publisher referencing the LocalBusiness @id in [CV: business_schema_id]. Never a second LocalBusiness block.
- FAQPage from the same site wide snippet, reading blog_faq_items.
- BreadcrumbList from the Rank Math trail.

Backfill. When a cost guide publishes, its URL is marked Live in the Page Map, and the matching service page's prices section, the category page's cost section and, for the homepage cost guide, the homepage FAQ Q1 link to it on their next push.

Tracking. As every page: phone_click and quote_click.

Design notes by section

Section	Design
1. Post header	H1, then byline and last checked date on one quiet line; photo full width under it, or none
2. Quick answer	Tinted box with a thin left border, no heading; reads at a glance
3. Question sections	Comfortable reading width, about 70 characters a line; H2s clearly larger than body
4. Table	Full width of the text column, scrolls sideways on mobile, header row shaded

Section	Design
5. How we handle it	Subtle card, same width as the text
6. FAQ	H3 question, answer underneath, all visible; no accordion
7. Next step	The homepage final CTA component, centred, buttons

Never stock images anywhere on the page.

11. QA checklist and open items

Pre-publish QA (on the live or scheduled post, in mobile Chrome):

- ☐ No BLOCK left in VALIDATION; every FLAG looked at; claims accepted or fixed
- ☐ H1 is the target question, 70 characters or fewer; SEO title 60 characters or fewer
- ☐ The quick answer answers the H1 in its first sentence
- ☐ Primary link works and points to a live page; no link to a page that isn't live
- ☐ Every price is from the price list; every rule says "usually" and names no regulation
- ☐ No FAQ question repeats one used elsewhere on the site
- ☐ Section and FAQ word counts are within the post type range
- ☐ BlogPosting and FAQPage schema validate; publisher references the LocalBusiness @id; no second LocalBusiness
- ☐ Page search finds no "[", "CV:", "HIDDEN" or another client's name or town
- ☐ No stock image; table scrolls on mobile without breaking the page
- ☐ Scheduled date matches the Page Map

Rollout test (before any live client): run the first 15 topics on paper, then through Copybot, for three clients: Eden's Edge (landscaper, type A, no price list, 0 reviews), a roofer (type A, full data, emergency niche) and a dog walker (type C, no category layer). It passes when there's no BLOCK, flags match the expected ones, and no two posts make the same point.

Open items

Decisions, each with a default so none blocks the build:

- ☐ **Price ranges:** a firm yes or no, and the onboarding question ("What's the typical price range for each main service? A from and to price is fine.")
- ☐ **Byline:** owner name and role when on file (default), or company only?
- ☐ **Specificity threshold:** 4 of 6 (default), dropping to 3 from month four for thin niches?
- ☐ **URL:** /guides/ (default) or /blog/? Whichever is chosen applies to cost guides too.

Needed before Copybot can run this structure:

- page-types/blog.js (fields, word ranges, validator, reader view, WordPress mapping) and decisions B1 to B15
- Blog CORE (1), from sections 2 to 9 (draft in Appendix A)
- Blog field groups in wp/acf-schema.js, regenerated into the plugin
- The push writing to posts with a future date, and the backfill step
- The niche slot additions in section 3 for all 28 niches

- The Cost Guide Structure tab (Brandon)
- Given: the single post template and the Guides archive

Appendix A: Blog CORE (1) prompt

Draft v1, written in the shape of Service CORE (17) from sections 2 to 9 above. Code appends prompts/_shared_copy_rules.md under SHARED COPY RULES, so claims, voice, links, names in prose and custom values aren't repeated here. Field names and word ranges match section 6.

```
# Blog Post Copywriting Prompt: CORE (1)

New page type for v20. Draft v1, 26 Oct 2026. Master copy lives in the Copybot repo;
edit there, copy to the project.

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## HOW THIS PROMPT IS USED

This one prompt writes every blog post. POST says which type it is:

- cost_guide: owns "[service] cost [city]" (or "[trade] cost [city]" for the homepage
cost guide). Explains what the job costs and why. Prices only from [CV: price_list];
with no price list it becomes "what affects the cost" (cost_mode: factors).
- decision: "X or Y", "repair or replace", "do I need planning permission for X".
Helps the reader choose, then points to the service that does it.
- question: one customer question ("why is my lawn waterlogged?", "how long does a
patio take?"). Answers it, then points to the service that fixes it.
- local: a problem or condition in one named town or neighbourhood, from the geo
dossier. Seasonal posts are local posts with a time of year.

A blog post earns its place by answering one real customer question with facts only
this business, in this area, could give. It gets cited in AI answers because it
answers first, uses the customer's question as headings and carries checkable local
detail. It is never filler.

Copybot's code has already:

- chosen the post type, the target query, the H1, SEO title, meta description and
URL;
- chosen the 3 to 5 H2s (the query stack: the questions a person asks around the
target query), each with a one line brief;
- decided whether the post has a table, and given its columns and row labels;
- chosen the 3 to 5 FAQ questions, none used anywhere else on the site;
- chosen the primary link (one service page, category page or the homepage) and up to
two secondary links;
- decided whether the business block shows and whether the safety switch is on;
- listed the facts this post may use: client values, the dossier rows, the trade
facts rows and the customer question in the customer's words;
- listed the ideas the homepage, category, service and other blog pages have already
made.

You write the prose fields only. Everything in DECISIONS is fixed. Do not change it,
```

```
repeat it back, or write anything outside the fields listed in MODEL FIELDS.

## WHAT YOU RECEIVE

Cached client block: CLIENT VALUES, NICHE ENTRY, CALIBRATION PACK, as for the service page.

Per post message, in this order:
1. POST: post_type, cost_mode (cost guides), URL, target query, service, category, town (local posts).
2. DECISIONS: H1, H2s with briefs, table columns and row labels, FAQ questions with doubts, primary and secondary links, switches, publish date.
3. FACTS ALLOWED: the client values, TRADE FACTS rows and DOSSIER rows this post may state, each with an ID.
4. LINKABLE PAGES: the only URLs you may link to.
5. IDEAS USED ELSEWHERE: points other pages already make.
6. MODEL FIELDS: the exact fields you must write.

---

## THE FIELDS YOU WRITE

Word counts are hard ranges. Count before you finish.

### blog_answer
40 to 60 words. The direct answer to the target query, first sentence 20 words or fewer. Cost guide with a price list: the typical range from [CV: price_list] and the one thing that moves it most. Factors mode: what moves the price, no figures. Decision: which option suits which situation. Question: the answer, then the most common cause. Local: the condition and what it means for the job. Never open on the company name.

### blog_sections
One body per H2 in DECISIONS, in order. Each body opens with a sentence that answers its H2 directly, then 2 or 3 short paragraphs following the brief. Range per post type: cost guide 150 to 220 words each; decision and question 140 to 200; local 120 to 180. Every paragraph carries one fact from FACTS ALLOWED. The primary link appears once in the first or second section, as natural link text.

### blog_table
Only when DECISIONS gives a table. One row per row label, in order, filling each column from FACTS ALLOWED. Prices only from [CV: price_list]; a cell with no fact is written "Ask for a quote", never a guess. 2 to 12 words per cell.

### blog_business
Only when DECISIONS shows the business block. 50 to 80 words. How this business handles the job: its quote method, process, guarantee or accreditation, from client values only. Written as what happens, never as a boast.

### blog_faq_items
One answer per question given, in order. 40 to 70 words. First sentence answers in 15 words or fewer. Prices only from [CV: price_list]. Rules from trade facts rule rows only, written as what usually applies.

### blog_closing
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```
One or two sentences, 20 to 40 words. What the reader can do next, linking the
primary page once. Never [CV: phone], never "Tell us", never the same opening words
as another closing line on the site.

### MODEL_FLAGS
One code per line or "none". F-SPECIFIC (fewer than four of the six specificity facts
were usable). F-FACTS-THIN (fewer than 3 trade facts rows for this topic). F-SAFETY
(the topic touches gas, electrics or structure; say how you handled it).

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## BLOG RULES

On top of the shared copy rules:

1. Answer first, always. Every H2 body and every FAQ answer starts with the answer,
not with context.
2. The customer's words. When FACTS ALLOWED gives the customer question in their own
words, use those words once, in the first section.
3. No stories. Never a scenario, an anecdote, a "picture this" or an imagined
customer. A real customer question is the only story allowed.
4. Rules and planning are written as what usually applies ("in most cases",
"usually"), never as legal advice, never with a standard's number or a regulation's
name. Say who to check with (the council, building control).
5. Safety switch on. What to switch off or avoid, then to call a qualified
professional. Never DIY steps.
6. Figures. Prices only from [CV: price_list]. Council fees and rules only from FACTS
ALLOWED rows. One figure per paragraph at most.
7. One home per idea. Nothing in IDEAS USED ELSEWHERE is made again. A point made in
one H2 is not repeated in the FAQ.
8. No proof headlines. Years, guarantee, insurance and review counts appear only in
blog_business, and only as confirmed.
9. Links. The primary link twice at most (a section and the closing line); each
secondary link once. Never link to another blog post unless it is on LINKABLE PAGES.
10. No promises the business can't control: say what the work does and what it
protects against.

---

## OUTPUT

=== MODEL OUTPUT: blog ===
blog_answer:
blog_sections:
  - h2: <as given> | body:
blog_table:
  - row: <as given> | cells: <cell> ; <cell> ; <cell>
blog_business:
blog_faq_items:
  - faq_question: <as given> | faq_answer:
blog_closing:
MODEL_FLAGS:

Paragraph breaks inside a body are written as \n\n on the same line. A field marked
HIDDEN in DECISIONS, or with no table given, is written as HIDDEN.
```

```
Before you output, check the judgement calls (code checks the rest):
1. blog_answer answers the target query in its first sentence.
2. Every H2 body opens by answering its H2.
3. Every paragraph carries a fact from FACTS ALLOWED, and nothing is stated that
isn't there.
4. No story, scenario or imagined customer.
5. Rules are what usually applies, never advice, never numbered.
6. Every section and FAQ answer is within its word range.
7. It sounds like the owner explaining the job to a neighbour.
```

Appendix B: Sample output

A decision post for Eden's Edge, written by hand to the structure and prompt above to show the shape, at full length. It isn't a CopyBot run yet. The council facts come from Southampton City Council and the Planning Portal (dropped kerbs, paving your front garden); in CopyBot they'd arrive as trade facts and dossier rows.

DECISIONS code would pass

Decision	Value
post_type	decision
Target query	planning permission front garden paving Southampton
blog_h1	Do You Need Planning Permission to Pave Your Front Garden? (57 characters; the city is dropped under B3 because the full question runs over 70)
section_h2s	When Do You Need Planning Permission? · What Counts as a Permeable Surface? · Do You Need a Dropped Kerb in Southampton? · Does a Conservation Area Change Anything?
table	on: Surface · Needs planning permission? (5 rows), after section 2
business_block	on (quote method and process confirmed)
Primary link	/patios-paving/ (service page)
Secondary link	/guides/patio-cost-southampton/ (cost guide, live)
Specificity	5 of 6: town, local rule, customer question, client process, named materials
safety	off

MODEL OUTPUT, rendered

Do You Need Planning Permission to Pave Your Front Garden?

blog_answer: Usually not, if the new surface lets water drain through. Gravel, permeable block paving and porous asphalt don't need planning permission at any size, and nor does a solid surface that drains onto a lawn or border. Driving onto it from the road needs a dropped kerb, which is a separate application to Southampton City Council.

When Do You Need Planning Permission?

You need it when more than five square metres of a front garden is covered with a solid surface and the rainwater has nowhere to soak away. If the surface is permeable, or the water runs onto a lawn or border inside the garden, permission usually isn't needed at any size.

The rule covers the paving only. Walls, fences, gates and a dropped kerb are dealt with separately, and each has its own rules, so a new front drive can involve more than one check before work starts.

The rule has been in place since October 2008, so a neighbour's older paved drive isn't a guide to what's allowed now. Many front gardens across Southampton were paved before then, and they don't show what the council would accept today.

Our patio and paving work starts by checking which side of that line a front garden sits on, before any design is drawn up.

What Counts as a Permeable Surface?

A permeable surface lets rain soak through it into the ground instead of running off into the road. That's the test the planning rule uses, so the material matters more than the size of the area being paved.

Gravel, permeable block paving and porous asphalt are all made to let water through, so they don't need planning permission however much of the front garden they cover. Each one needs the right base underneath to keep draining over the years, which is why the layers below the surface matter as much as the top.

Solid paving and concrete can still go ahead without permission when the water is directed onto a lawn, a border or a soakaway inside the garden rather than onto the pavement. Without that, a solid surface over five square metres usually needs an application.

Surface	Needs planning permission?
Gravel	No
Permeable block paving	No
Porous asphalt	No
Solid paving or concrete draining to a lawn or border	No
Solid paving or concrete over 5m² with no drainage	Usually yes

Do You Need a Dropped Kerb in Southampton?

Yes, if you'll drive across the pavement to park. Driving over a kerb that hasn't been lowered isn't allowed, so a new front drive for a car usually goes hand in hand with a dropped kerb application.

Southampton City Council charges a £160 application fee that isn't refunded, and it won't look at the application until any planning permission the drive needs has been granted. That makes the order important: sort out the paving first, then apply for the kerb.

The standard width is 4.6 metres, usually three lowered kerbs with a sloping kerb either side. Gates across the drive must open inwards, so they never swing out over the pavement.

The council approves the crossing but doesn't build it, so the kerb work is arranged separately once the approval comes through.

Does a Conservation Area Change Anything?

It can. In Southampton's conservation areas, changes to front walls, fences and some garden work may need permission, even when the same job on another street wouldn't.

Conservation areas protect the look of a street as a whole, so the council can take an interest in front gardens that sit in view of the road. Taking down a front wall to make space for parking is the kind of change that can need an extra check.

The simplest step is to find out whether the property sits in a conservation area before any work is booked. The council's planning team can confirm it, and can say whether the plans need an application.

If permission is needed, it's far easier to get it first than to change finished work afterwards.

How [CV: company_name] Handles Front Garden Paving

At the quote visit, we check the size of the front garden, the surface you want and where the water will go, so the plan stays within the rules. [The client's quote method and any confirmed guarantee would go here, from client values.]

Common Questions About Front Garden Paving

- **Is the dropped kerb fee refunded if I'm refused?** No. Southampton City Council's £160 charge is non refundable, whatever the outcome. That's why it's worth checking whether the drive needs planning permission first, because the council won't look at a dropped kerb application until any permission needed has been granted.
- **Can I drive over the kerb without one?** No. Driving over a pavement without a dropped kerb isn't allowed, and the council can charge for any damage to the footway. If you're planning to park on a new front drive, the dropped kerb application is part of the job, alongside the paving itself.
- **What happens if I pave without permission?** The council can ask for it to be changed or removed. If the paving needed permission and doesn't have it, putting it right usually costs more than doing it properly the first time, so it's worth checking the surface and the drainage before any work starts.

Talk to a Local Landscaper About Front Garden Paving

blog_closing: Planning a new front drive? See what goes into the price in our Southampton patio cost guide, or book a quote for your patio and paving work.

Checks it passes

- H1 is 57 characters, within the 70 limit (B3)
- Answer first, in 20 words or fewer (B-N1)
- Every H2 opens by answering itself, and every section is within the decision post range (140 to 200 words)
- Every FAQ answer is within 40 to 70 words, with a first sentence of 15 words or fewer
- No story or imagined customer (B-N5)
- Rules written as what usually applies, no regulation names (B-N4)
- Only price is a council fee from a fact row (B-N3)
- Primary link in section 1 and the closing line, twice in total (B-N2); the cost guide link once, at /guides/
- UK English, no dashes, no hyphenated compounds, no claim words

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What changed in this version

1. **Cost guides:** own structure tab (Brandon), running on this template as post_type cost_guide, matching the v1 page set decision.
2. **One URL pattern:** every post, cost guides included, at /guides/[slug]/; the sample's cost guide link updated to match.
3. **Homepage cost guide** added to the topic queue (B1) and the Page Map, feeding the homepage FAQ Q1 and the backfill.
4. **Primary link fallback:** the homepage services section when a service has no service or category page (B8, scaling rules).
5. **Topic order** matches the agreed order: cost guides, then customer questions (decision and question posts), then local and seasonal.
6. **Seasonal topics shared with GBP posts,** so both follow one calendar (section 3, B10).
7. **Sample H1** shortened to 57 characters, following B3.
8. **Sample sections** expanded to the decision post range (140 to 200 words each).
9. **Sample FAQ answers** expanded to 40 to 70 words.
10. **QA and the prompt's final check** now include word ranges, so short output is caught.

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